

Chapter 86-2 - Background

Inside an immortal wood residence, orange light was currently bursting outward, but the residence had a barrier set up outside that couldn't be broken through no matter what.

Two immortal attendants walked to the door with small steps, standing outside the barrier and bowing their heads: "Young Master, the family head requests your presence in the front courtyard."

Hearing this, the light suddenly disappeared. The door was pulled open, and Jiang Li appeared at the doorway with an angry expression: "Tell grandmother that I, Jiang Li, don't need any son-in-law. Tell those men to get as far away as possible!"

The two immortal attendants exchanged glances and said carefully: "But Young Master, the family head said that if you don't meet those people for even one day, she won't let you leave the mountain for one day."

"Yes, as long as the Young Master goes to meet those people, the family head will let you go out. Otherwise, you'll have to stay confined here, and we feel heartbroken watching."

Jiang Li clenched her fists and paced left and right anxiously, feeling very frustrated.

After she fainted that day, she woke up having been brought back to the Jiang family and was confined here. But she still remembered the task Chu Qingqiu had entrusted to her. She had tried several times to break out, but her grandmother's cultivation was far above hers, and she couldn't break free no matter what.

Fortunately, she heard that Ning Fuyi had already escaped from Penglai, but now she didn't know where she was. She couldn't entrust such an important item to the attendants to deliver, which truly made her anxious to death!

"Fine, fine! Isn't it just a few men? I'll meet them. Go back and tell grandmother that once I meet them, she must let me go out. I still have important matters to attend to and can't be confined like this anymore! Did you hear?" She ran to the barrier in a few steps.

"Wonderful! The Young Master finally agreed. We'll go report to the family head immediately!" The two attendants were overjoyed upon hearing this, bowing their heads and running outside.

Jiang Li pushed the immovable barrier hard twice and kicked away a stone on the ground in frustration.

Sure enough, after the time it takes to drink a cup of tea, those two attendants returned with keys, respectfully unlocking the barrier: "Young Master, the people are already waiting in the front courtyard. Young Master, please come with us."

First pretend to compromise, then once she reached the front courtyard, find an opportunity to escape and go see Ning Fuyi. Jiang Li's eyes rolled around as she coughed twice: "Lead the way."

From far away, she could see more than ten men standing in the front courtyard. Where they stood was a huge green stone circular platform in the courtyard, with a circle of flowing water around the platform.

This water wasn't ordinary water, but the Regretless Soup brewed by the Jiang family. Anyone who came seeking medical treatment had to wade through this water. Those with evil intentions would feel as if they were stepping into boiling oil, while those with kind hearts could pass through safely.

It seemed these dozen or so people were the selected potential sons-in-law.

Jiang Li felt frustrated, but knowing she couldn't escape, she flew forward and landed in front of the men, using a veil to cover her hand as she lifted each of their chins one by one.

"This one is too thin." She pushed him away disdainfully and turned to the next one.

"This one is too short."

"This one is too tall, this one is too dark."

Her words were merciless, and those rejected covered their faces in shame. In the blink of an eye, she had reached the last one. Just as she was forcefully gripping his chin to say something, her eyes suddenly widened.

"Rarely..." She suddenly met those phoenix eyes, her mouth opening and closing, "A rarely seen beauty."

She brushed aside her hair and smiled at the two immortal attendants staring at her: "This person is not bad. Go tell grandmother that I've taken a liking to one and am taking him back to cultivate feelings."

With that, she wrapped her arm around the "man's" shoulder, her robes fluttering as they disappeared in the sunlight.

"Eh, although this man looks decent, he's not even as tall as that short one. How could the Young Master like him?" One attendant stretched his neck to look.

"Why do you care? The Young Master has finally come to her senses!" Another attendant quietly celebrated. "Hurry and report to the family head!"

Meanwhile, Jiang Li had already blasted open a door with one palm, thrown the slender "man" inside, and closed the door again.

"Young Sect Leader! How did you..." Jiang Li let out a long sigh of relief. "Heaven be praised, I thought I'd never see you again in this lifetime. If I hadn't completed the Divine Venerable's entrustment, I would have died of anxiety."

Ning Fuyi was nearly thrown off balance. She barely managed to steady herself against the table edge and removed the magical artifact that had changed her appearance: "Medical Immortal Jiang, I still have injuries. Please be gentler."

"My apologies." Jiang Li pressed her palms together apologetically. She came forward and sent out several silver threads to probe Ning Fuyi's pulse, her smile freezing on her face. "This... Penglai actually used such torture on you, nearly destroying your immortal veins. Your five organs and six viscera are also full of wounds."

"Doesn't Penglai have quite a reputation? How could they be so heavy-handed with a small disciple?" Her eyes reddened slightly. "What about Jiuying?"

"She's fine." Ning Fuyi forced a smile, though her voice trembled slightly. "You mentioned the Divine Venerable's entrustment earlier - what entrustment?"

Hearing this, Jiang Li quickly took out the jade pendant Chu Qingqiu had left with her and handed it to Ning Fuyi.

The moment the cold jade pendant fell into her palm, Ning Fuyi's heart surged with emotion, feeling as if it weighed a thousand pounds.

"This is what she left for me?" she asked again.

She had thought Chu Qingqiu was truly that heartless, not leaving her a single word before departing, unwilling to look back at her even as she died. But she never expected that she had actually left something for her.

She suddenly felt somewhat dazed. It turned out that as long as Chu Qingqiu showed her even the slightest bit of kindness, she could be this satisfied.

"Yes, the Divine Venerable knew long ago that she would die, so she left this with me beforehand, asking me to give it to you after her death, saying there were things inside she wanted to tell you." Since Chu Qingqiu was gone anyway, Jiang Li spoke frankly.

Ning Fuyi gripped the jade pendant, her phoenix eyes downcast.

"What do you mean she knew she would die? Did she know she would perish together with the demon clan, or was it because of her injuries..." Ning Fuyi keenly caught the loophole in Jiang Li's words.

"Both." Jiang Li sighed. "The Divine Venerable's old injuries were too severe, and she repeatedly forced herself to overdraw her immortal power. She only had one year of life left. Since killing the demon clan was necessary, she simply gave up that one year of life in exchange for the safety of Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate and you."

"I think it was precisely because of this that she... didn't want to admit that it was her who dual cultivated with you." Jiang Li said quietly.

"My safety..." Ning Fuyi's eyes stung. She turned away, her voice cold and hard. "I don't understand. What harm would there have been in telling me? Am I so untrustworthy in her heart?"

"The Divine Venerable said she was afraid you would fall into demonhood because of it." Jiang Li fidgeted with her sleeve corner. "But I always felt that she kept everything from you not just because of these reasons."

Ning Fuyi laughed coldly and shook her head: "Fall into demonhood - because of the tree in my consciousness sea?"

Jiang Li looked up: "You actually know about it?"

"That's my consciousness sea. How could I not guess? What damaged soul - souls can only be incomplete. Whose soul can be 'injured'?" Ning Fuyi stood there in her black robes like a shoulder draped in gloom.

"She's just that kind of person, maintaining her lofty airs, forever stubborn and opinionated." Ning Fuyi felt hurt inside, hatred and sorrow intertwining. "She always has things hidden from me. I can never understand her."

Jiang Li didn't know what to say. The situation between Chu Qingqiu and Ning Fuyi was too complicated. She was already one of the more knowledgeable people, but the more she knew, the more confused she became.

Originally, she naturally stood on Chu Qingqiu's side, but seeing Ning Fuyi in such a state now, her heart ached for her too.

When they first met, although she felt Ning Fuyi's gaze was complex and not simple, the Ning Fuyi of that time still had some carefree youthful spirit about her. But now, after all these events, that bit of youthful spirit was completely gone.

Standing there now, she was like a winter night - piercingly dark.

"I'm sorry, Medical Immortal Jiang." Ning Fuyi imperceptibly wiped away the moisture at the corner of her eyes and carefully took something out of a thought bead, placing it on the table.

"There's one more thing I need your help with. Look at this."

Jiang Li looked down, her dark brows furrowing into a knot: "What is this?"

"This is what Chu Qingqiu's body turned into. I didn't dare ask others, fearing someone might covet it." Ning Fuyi reached out to touch the small sprout.

The green little sprout seemed to have grown accustomed to her touch. It swayed its body and wrapped its two green leaves around Ning Fuyi's fingertip.

Jiang Li covered her mouth with her hand, unable to believe her eyes. She sent a thread of immortal power into the soil to probe, stammering: "This... this is a pot of gardenia flowers, but there's a hidden power inside. It's definitely not an ordinary gardenia."

"So I wanted to ask Medical Immortal if you know anything about Chu Qingqiu's past."

"I don't know either." Jiang Li swallowed hard, her throat tight. "Everyone knows of the Divine Venerable's appearance because of that great battle two thousand years ago. They all say she was a genius who appeared out of nowhere, but before that, no one had ever seen Chu Qingqiu."

"Then does Medical Immortal know if there are any precedents of the spirit clan cultivating to become immortals?" Ning Fuyi continued asking.

Jiang Li shook her head repeatedly: "The spirit clan is the weakest of the six realms. It would be a blessing if they weren't eaten by others. I've lived for several hundred years and have never heard of any spirit clan member cultivating to become immortal, let alone someone as powerful as the Divine Venerable."

Ning Fuyi lowered her eyes, looking at the little sprout that was currently wrapping around her finger in circles, and suddenly said: "I hate Chu Qingqiu. Chu Qingqiu is a detestable ghost with no feelings and no heart."

As soon as she finished speaking, the previously clingy little sprout suddenly stiffened, then forcefully slapped her fingertip twice before burying its head back into the soil.

The room fell into silence.

"Could it be that..." Jiang Li rubbed her face with difficulty, staring at the trembling little sprout. "The Divine Venerable really isn't human?"

Author's Note:

Little Sprout Divine Venerable: How dare you insult me! I'll hit you! (Huffing angrily)